

D751

Advanced Clinical in Elementary and Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A candidate plans a fourth-grade lesson on comparing decimals. The class recently finished a fundraiser, and the school uses a new math curriculum. Which planning step best anticipates a misconception?

- A. Plan to reteach the whole lesson if many students get it wrong.
- B. Use fundraiser totals as examples.
- C. Follow the new curriculum exactly, since it covers everything.
- D. Include a pair like 0.5 and 0.45 and ask which is greater and why, to bring out the 'more digits means bigger' idea.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

In a fifth-grade science discussion about why ice melts faster on metal, students take turns saying their ideas but never respond to each other. The class has 26 students and the room has lab tables. What should the candidate add?

- A. A rule that only the teacher can call on students.
- B. Split the class into groups of 26 lab stations.
- C. More time so every student can share once.
- D. Stems like "I agree with ___ because..." and "Can you show evidence for...?" and a norm that each speaker responds to the last one.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A candidate introduces two-digit multiplication to a group that includes students with math learning disabilities. The lesson is after art, and the group chose a space theme. What is the best sequence?

- A. Watch one example, then do 30 problems.
- B. Study a fully worked example, then complete examples with the last step missing, then more steps missing, then solve alone.
- C. Solve ten problems alone, then review answers.
- D. Solve space-themed story problems first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Students have practiced with faded examples and now solve most problems correctly on their own. What should the teacher do next?

- A.** Go back to fully worked examples.
- B.** Keep faded examples for the rest of the year.
- C.** Shift to independent problem solving with varied problems.
- D.** Stop practice and move to a new topic.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Before a unit test on the water cycle, a candidate plans a 15-minute review. The class just returned from a field trip to a reservoir, and the test is Friday. Which review uses retrieval practice?

- A.** The teacher shows the unit slides again.
- B.** Students reread their notes quietly.
- C.** Students close notes, write everything they remember about each stage, then check and fix it.
- D.** Students share photos from the reservoir trip.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants retrieval practice to be low-stakes. Which feature matters most?

- A.** Quizzes are ungraded or lightly weighted, with feedback.
- B.** Quizzes happen only once at the end of the unit.
- C.** Each quiz counts for 20% of the grade.
- D.** Students may use notes on every quiz.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A candidate plans a 50-minute lesson: 10-minute warm-up, 20-minute teacher explanation, 5-minute guided practice, and a 5-minute exit ticket. The class meets in the new wing, and it is spirit week. How many minutes are left for independent practice, and what should change?

- A. 10 minutes; shorten the explanation and warm-up to give more guided and independent practice.
- B. 10 minutes; lengthen the explanation so students understand before practice.
- C. 15 minutes; the plan is balanced.
- D. 20 minutes; that matches the explanation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants guided plus independent practice to take 60% of a 45-minute lesson. How many minutes are left for everything else?

- A. 18
- B. 27
- C. 15
- D. 40

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A candidate writes today's target on the board for second graders. The standard is 2.MD.1, and the class earned a popcorn party last week. Which target is best?

- A. "I can earn another popcorn party."
- B. "Ruler worksheet."
- C. "I can measure objects in inches using a ruler."
- D. "2.MD.1"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

At the end of a lesson, a teacher wants students to self-check against the target “I can explain why a character changed.” Which exit question matches it?

- A.** “Circle the standard code we worked on.”
- B.** “How did the main character change, and what event caused it? Use a detail.”
- C.** “Name the main character.”
- D.** “Did you like the story?”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A candidate plans a whole-class writing lesson. One student’s IEP lists speech-to-text and a graphic organizer; another’s 504 plan lists preferential seating. The co-teacher is a strong writer who recently won an award. How should the candidate plan?

- A.** Give every student speech-to-text.
- B.** Ask the co-teacher to model her award-winning writing.
- C.** Assume the co-teacher will handle it.
- D.** List each support in the plan (device ready, organizer copies, seating) and note who provides it and when.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A candidate says, “Get your notebook, write the date, answer the three questions, then trade with a partner and check.” Many students ask what to do. The class just moved rooms and gets a new pencil sharpener tomorrow. What should she change?

- A.** Ask, “Any questions?”
- B.** Post the steps numbered, give them one or two at a time, and have a student repeat them before starting.
- C.** Repeat the same directions louder.
- D.** Wait until the room move settles down.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A candidate plans a fourth-grade lesson on comparing decimals. ~~The class recently finished a fundraiser, and the school uses a new math curriculum.~~ Which planning step best anticipates a misconception?

Target word: plan for misconceptions **Decides:** A known wrong idea: longer decimals are bigger.

A	Inverted operation	Waits for errors instead of anticipating them.
B	Camouflage	Adds context without targeting the misconception.
C	Absolute language	No curriculum fits every class; planning for errors is still needed.
D	Correct	Targets a common, predictable misconception.

2. Answer D Concept 2

In a fifth-grade science discussion about why ice melts faster on metal, students take turns saying their ideas but never respond to each other. ~~The class has 26 students and the room has lab tables.~~ What should the candidate add?

Target word: make talk accountable **Decides:** Students do not build on or question each other.

A	Inverted operation	Centers the teacher instead of peer talk.
B	Camouflage	Uses the class size and tables; does not change how students talk.
C	Dropped element	More turns without responding is still not discussion.
D	Correct	Norms and stems require building on ideas and evidence.

3. Answer B Concept 3

A candidate introduces two-digit multiplication to a group that includes students with math learning disabilities. ~~The lesson is after art, and the group chose a space theme.~~ What is the best sequence?

Target word: sequence for novices **Decides:** New multi-step procedure for novices.

A	Dropped element	Drops the fading steps.
B	Correct	Worked then faded examples reduce load for novices.
C	Inverted operation	Starts with independent solving before examples.
D	Camouflage	Theme does not decide sequence.

4. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

Students have practiced with faded examples and now solve most problems correctly on their own. What should the teacher do next?

Target word: reverse: when to stop worked examples **Decides:** Learners are no longer novices.

A	Inverted operation	Returns to a novice support they no longer need.
B	Absolute language	Support should fade as skill grows.
C	Correct	Once students are competent, more worked examples add little.
D	Dropped element	Drops independent practice.

5. Answer C Concept 4

Before a unit test on the water cycle, a candidate plans a 15-minute review. ~~The class just returned from a field trip to a reservoir,~~ and the test is Friday. Which review uses retrieval practice?

Target word: effective review **Decides:** Students recall from memory.

A	Adjacent category	Re-exposure, not retrieval.
B	Confusion set	Rereading feels familiar but is weaker.
C	Correct	Recall from memory strengthens learning.
D	Camouflage	Uses the trip detail; not retrieval of content.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A teacher wants retrieval practice to be low-stakes. Which feature matters most?

Target word: reverse: design condition **Decides:** Retrieval works without high stakes.

A	Correct	Low stakes reduce anxiety while keeping recall benefits.
B	Adjacent category	Spacing and frequency matter; one quiz is a test.
C	Inverted operation	Makes it high stakes.
D	Dropped element	Drops the recall from memory.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A candidate plans a 50-minute lesson: 10-minute warm-up, 20-minute teacher explanation, 5-minute guided practice, and a 5-minute exit ticket. ~~The class meets in the new wing, and it is spirit week.~~ How many minutes are left for independent practice, and what should change?

Target word: pacing math and fix **Decides:** $50 - (10 + 20 + 5 + 5)$.

A	Correct	$10 + 20 + 5 + 5 = 40$; $50 - 40 = 10$, and practice deserves more time.
B	Inverted operation	Right number, wrong fix: more talk takes more time from practice.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the 5-minute exit ticket; the correct figure is 10.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses the explanation time.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher wants guided plus independent practice to take 60% of a 45-minute lesson. How many minutes are left for everything else?

Target word: solve for the remainder **Decides:** 40% of 45.

A	Correct	60% of 45 = 27 minutes of practice; $45 - 27 = 18$.
B	Inverted operation	That is the practice time, not what is left.
C	Wrong stem number	$45 - 30$ treats 60% as 30 minutes.
D	Confusion set	40 is the percent left, not minutes.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A candidate writes today's target on the board for second graders. The standard is 2.MD.1, ~~and the class earned a popcorn party last week~~. Which target is best?

Target word: student-friendly target **Decides:** An 'I can' in student language naming what they do.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the learning goal.
B	Adjacent category	An activity, not a learning goal.
C	Correct	Student language naming the skill.
D	Dropped element	A code with no meaning to students.

10. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

At the end of a lesson, a teacher wants students to self-check against the target "I can explain why a character changed." Which exit question matches it?

Target word: reverse: from target to check **Decides:** The check must require the target skill.

A	Adjacent category	Checks labels, not learning.
B	Correct	Requires explaining the change with evidence.
C	Dropped element	Drops the explanation of change.
D	Confusion set	Opinion, not the target skill.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A candidate plans a whole-class writing lesson. One student's IEP lists speech-to-text and a graphic organizer; another's 504 plan lists preferential seating. The co-teacher is a strong writer ~~who recently won an award~~. How should the candidate plan?

Target word: build in supports **Decides:** Supports must appear in the plan itself.

A	Absolute language	Universal tools can help, but the plan must still ensure each student's supports.
B	Camouflage	Uses the award detail; ignores supports.
C	Dropped element	Drops the planning step.
D	Correct	Planned supports are delivered reliably.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A candidate says, "Get your notebook, write the date, answer the three questions, then trade with a partner and check." Many students ask what to do. ~~The class just moved rooms and gets a new pencil sharpener tomorrow~~. What should she change?

Target word: fix directions **Decides:** Many steps given once orally.

A	Dropped element	Drops a real check for understanding.
B	Correct	Chunked, visual directions with a check prevent confusion.
C	Confusion set	Volume does not fix too many steps at once.
D	Camouflage	Uses the room detail; directions are the issue.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	9	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Anticipating misconceptions	Before teaching, predict the most likely wrong ideas and plan a question, example, or task that brings them out and addresses them.	Waiting to see what goes wrong and then reteaching the same way.	A planning question about what students might get wrong.
2	Accountable talk	Students speak to each other using norms and stems that require reasons, evidence, and building on others' ideas.	Counting any student talk as productive discussion.	Students take turns sharing but never respond to each other.
3	Worked and faded examples	Novices learn well from fully worked examples, then examples with steps removed, before solving on their own.	Giving beginners many problems to solve alone right away.	Students are new to a multi-step procedure.
4	Retrieval practice	Having students recall information from memory (low-stakes quizzes, brain dumps) strengthens learning more than rereading or reviewing notes.	Using rereading or re-showing notes as review.	A teacher plans review before a test.
5	Lesson segment pacing	Plan minutes for each segment so they add up to the period, with the most time for guided and independent practice.	Planning a long opening and running out of time for practice.	A lesson length and a list of segment times.
6	Student-friendly learning targets	Share the lesson goal as an 'I can' statement in student language that names what they will be able to do.	Posting the standard code or an activity name as the target.	A target written on the board.
7	Planning supports for identified learners	Build each student's IEP or 504 accommodations and needed supports directly into the whole-class lesson plan.	Assuming a co-teacher or aide will handle supports without planning them.	A lesson plan for a class that includes students with IEPs or 504 plans.
8	Clear multi-step directions	Give directions in short, numbered steps, show them visually, and check understanding before releasing students.	Giving all steps once orally and asking, 'Any questions?'	Students start a task and many ask what to do.

Course scope (public description): Advanced Clinical provides aspiring educators with real-world classroom experience. This course emphasizes the importance of hands-on learning, offering candidates the unique opportunity to observe and participate in classroom environments under the guidance of experienced mentors. The curriculum includes demonstrating reflective practice, classroom engagement techniques, instructional strategies, and effective communication skills with students and colleagues through a pedagogical performance assessment. Through this immersive experience, candidates not only observe the daily responsibilities of a teacher, but also start to develop their own teaching style and philosophy, laying a solid foundation for their future careers in education. This course is taken immediately prior to Student Teaching I as part of an engaging and intensive clinical experience.